

PROJECT: IN THE NAME OF LOVE

CHAPTER 1 - SIDE A: NARRATIVE STEP OUTLINE

SETTING: Lincourt City (aka "Akumu City"). An island between Japan and South Korea. A hub for paranormal activity. **TONE:** Dark Fantasy / Magical Girl Deconstruction / Horror / Comedy.

PROLOGUE: THE LAST GUARDIAN

Location: Lincourt City (Airspace / City Center) **Characters:** Mori Midori, Kaiju King, Reporter (Cassidy), Love (The Cat)

- **THE SETUP:** Chaos in Lincourt City. A massive, Godzilla-esque creature is leveling buildings, contained only by a massive force shield. News reporter Cassidy broadcasts from a helicopter, hyping the arrival of the "City's Guardian."
- **HERO ENTRANCE:** Mori Midori arrives. She contrasts the destruction with a violently organic aesthetic—wearing a dress of leaves and branches, wielding a bark shield and a giant green onion (leek) sword.
- **THE NARRATIVE DEVICE (THE TRANSLATION):** Midori attempts diplomacy.
 - *The Public Perception:* To the reporter and the world, the Kaiju just roars terrifyingly.
 - *The Reader's Reality:* The narrative translates the roars into articulate, polite English, revealing the Kaiju is not a beast, but a desperate King.
 - *Dialogue:* "I am deeply sorry, but I must take this lands for my people... As a king, I must put the safety of my people before my pride."
- **THE CONFLICT:** Midori refuses. She explains she cannot surrender Lincourt because the people here worked hard for it. She offers a compromise: she will go to *his* world to help.
 - *The Tragic Refusal:* The Kaiju declines. It is too late; the "Evil" has likely followed him here already. He decides he must destroy her to secure the land. "I must put you down, and prepare my people for battle."
- **THE CLIMAX:** They clash.
 - Midori chants: "Bastet; grant me the key of any lock... Direct me to heart of evil." Her leek transforms into a spear ("ExcaLEEKbur!").
 - The Kaiju counters with a move that sounds like a comic book attack: "Atomic Quazar Blast!"
- **THE FALL:** Midori flies directly through the beam, tanking the damage to deliver the killing blow. A blinding flash ensues.
- **THE DEATHBED:** Midori kneels on a rooftop, battered. The Kaiju stands motionless, a leaf-shaped hole in his chest.
 - *Regret:* The Kaiju realizes his pride prevented an alliance. "Perhaps we could have joined forces against evil."
 - *The Final Request:* He begs Midori to save his son from making the same mistake. "As soon as the news of his father's death reach to him, he will try to avenge me. Convince him otherwise."

- **THE OATH:** Midori performs a serious *chiburi* (blood flick). She roars back (translated for the reader): "On my honor, it shall be done." The Kaiju dissolves into glittering magic dust.
- **THE REALITY CHECK:** Midori mourns quietly, but the moment is undercut by Love, a black cat smoking a cigarette.
 - *Love:* "Done with your theatrics? The show must go on sweetheart."
 - *Midori:* She drops the warrior facade for a warm smile. "Every life is worth fighting for, Love. Every life is worth mourning for."
 - *Love:* "Yeah, yeah. Keep the sermon for later."
- **PUBLIC PERSONA:** Midori flies up to the camera, switching to a bubbly magical girl persona. "Always eat your veggies!" She poses and flies off, leaving the reporter confused but excited.

SCENE 1: THE DREAM (RURAL JAPAN)

Location: Rural Japan (20 years ago) **Characters:** Tamami Hanami (Child), Mother

- **THE FLASHBACK:** A 6-year-old Tamami watches the broadcast on an old TV in a rural home. She mimics Midori's pose.
- **THE ASPIRATION:** Tamami tells her mother, "I want to be just like Miss Midori when I grow up!"
- **THE PARENTAL MASK:** The mother fakes excitement to protect her daughter's innocence.
 - *Interiority:* The mother suppresses her cynicism about their reality (rural life, limited opportunity). She hugs Tamami: "You will, my little song. You surely will."

SCENE 2: THE REALITY (PRESENT DAY)

Location: Lincourt City - Magical Girl Cafe **Characters:** Tamami Hanami (Adult/30s), Otaku Customers, Kaminari Torey

- **THE DISAPPOINTMENT:** 20 years later. Tamami has technically "become" Midori, but it's a hollow victory. She is wearing a cheap plastic costume, singing "Bastet! Guide me into the hearts..." in a sad cafe for lonely, balding men.
- **THE INCITING INCIDENT:** While performing, Tamami spots Kaminari Torey in the crowd—a delinquent student from the history class Tamami teaches. Torey is filming her and laughing.
- **THE FLIGHT:** Overcome with shame, Tamami runs backstage mid-song. The crowd boos.
- **THE CONFRONTATION:** Torey corners Tamami backstage with a shit-eating grin.
 - *The Insult:* Torey calls her "**Miss Tatami**" (implying she is a doormat).
 - *Tamami:* Weakly corrects her: "My name is Tamami..."
- **THE BLACKMAIL:** Torey holds the video as leverage. She blackmails Tamami: Go out and sing a specific song of Torey's choice, or the video goes public.
- **THE HUMILIATION:** Tamami complies. She performs with desperate, frantic energy. The crowd loves it; Torey laughs cruelly.
- **THE CLOSING SHIFT:**
 - Torey jokes about blackmailing for grades ("You have to pass me on every exa-").
 - **The Crack (Comedic Beat):** Tamami punches the wall, cracking it slightly. This isn't magic; it's purely the "hysteric strength" of a tired, exploited 30-year-old woman at her breaking

point.

- Torey backpedals: "Did I say that!? ... I meant that I already deleted it, haha."
- **THE LOCKER ROOM:** Tamami undresses. Torey barges in, comfortable in the space.
 - Tamami asks the real question: "What are *you* doing HERE, Torey?"
 - Torey flushes and deflects ("My loser radar went crazy").
 - A coworker waves goodbye to both, revealing Torey is actually a regular here, exposing her lie.

SCENE 3: THE WALK HOME

Location: Streets of Lincourt (Night) **Characters:** Tamami, Torey

- **WALK AND TALK (THE PARALLEL LIVES):** They walk home together, bonding over their shared secrets.
 - **Tamami's Secret:** She teaches history (prestige) but works at the cafe (shame) because the pay is terrible. She reveals she came from a farm in Japan to be an idol, but the industry was too harsh, so she fell back on teaching.
 - **Torey's Secret:** She comes to the cafe because she loves singing but is terrible at it. The "fat losers" give her the validation her powerful, strict father denies her.
- **SHARED IDOL:** They realize they both genuinely admire the original Mori Midori.
 - *Dialogue:* Torey is shocked a "hag" can be an idol. Tamami snaps, "I'm barely 30."
- **THE GUN GAG:** Two drunks start catcalling them.
 - Tamami tries to walk away ("Teacher mode").
 - Torey pulls a gun on them, screaming like a gangster. The men flee in terror.
 - *The Reveal:* Tamami freaks out, asking why she has a gun. Torey pulls the trigger—it's just a realistic lighter.
 - *Tamami:* "You shouldn't smoke either."

SCENE 4: THE MONSTERS ARRIVE

Location: Streets (Away from the girls) **Characters:** The Drunks, Nyall R. Thotep (The Hat Man), The Monstrous Man

- **THE VILLAINS:** The drunks, angry about the "crazy bitches," spot a voluptuous woman down the street.
- **THE TRAP:** They approach to harass "her."
 - *Dialogue:* One of the drunks jeers: "Hey, bombshell, wanna have some fun?"
- **THE REVEAL:** It is actually Nyall R. Thotep ("The Hat Man"), an eldritch figure in a suit and top hat.
 - *Thotep's Response:* "Fun? Oh, how exciting! I do much adore having fun! Say, I do have a fun idea in mind?"
- **THE TRANSFORMATION:** A massive, Monstrous Man appears from behind Thotep and snatches the drunks.

SCENE 5: THE ATTACK

Location: Streets / Dead End Alley **Characters:** Tamami, Torey, The "Dickhead" Monsters

- **THE RETURN:** The girls hear whistling behind them. Torey tries to use the lighter trick again ("It's those weezos again"), assuming it's just the drunks. It fails.
- **THE HORROR REVEAL:** The men have been transformed into "Dickhead" monsters.
 - *Visuals:* Phallic imagery—gland-shaped heads, long flaccid necks that swing while whistling, bulbous protuberances on the throat.
 - *Reaction:* Upon seeing the girls, their necks become rigid ("erect") and they charge.
- **THE FLIGHT:** Torey freezes in terror. Tamami snaps into "Teacher Mode" and drags her away. They run into a dead-end alley.
 - *Tech Failure:* Torey screams that her phone has no signal, despite being in the city center (classic horror trope).
- **THE SACRIFICE:** Trapped, Tamami realizes she has to save her student.
 - *Tamami:* "I will... distract them. Then you run. It's my duty... as a teacher."
 - *Torey:* "Yeah, in high school!" (Snarking even in the face of death).
 - Torey tries to take action ("Hey, you fucks! Here!"), but she is outmatched.
- **THE FATAL BLOW:** The monsters attack. Tamami jumps in front of Torey. The blow destroys her suitcase, rips her suit, and pierces her body. She collapses, bleeding out.
- **DESPAIR:** Torey screams for help. Tamami's inner monologue reflects on her unfulfilled life as the monsters prepare to finish them off.

SCENE 6: THE RESCUE & THE PACT

Location: Alleyway **Characters:** Tamami, Torey, Mori Midori, Love

- **THE SAVE:** A green flash cuts through the dark. The monsters are bisected and revert to human forms. Mori Midori stands there, but she is battered, dirty, and exhausted (implying she has been fighting all night).
- **THE FAN GORL:** Torey momentarily forgets the danger to take selfies, before snapping back to reality: "Please! Midori-sensei! My friend! She's—like—Dying I don't know!"
- **THE DILEMMA:** Midori assesses the wound. It is fatal.
 - *Enter Love:* The cat appears in a bowtie, urging them to leave.
 - *Midori:* "We can't just leave two citizens here to their demise, Love."
 - *Torey:* "Leave us? ... I can't die next to someone poor." (To Tamami): "No offense."
 - *Tamami:* She smiles, not scared. "Mi...dori..."
- **THE COST OF MAGIC:** Midori wants to heal her.
 - *Love's Warning:* "Oh, no you won't young lady. You are almost out of **Primater**." (Primater = Prime + Mater, magical life force).
 - *Midori:* "Love, every life is w—"
 - *Love:* "Shut it! I'm tired of hearing it." He puffs his cigar, resigned. He places his paws on her hands to assist. "This hag's life BETTER be worth the effort."
 - *Tamami (Whispering):* "I'm...barely...in my 30s."

- **THE HEALING:** Green and black energy flows into Tamami. Midori's dress withers, and she nearly faints from the exertion.
 - *Midori:* "Her wound, it was fatal. Healing it took a big toll on me."
 - *Love:* "From *us*, you mean."
- **THE RESURRECTION:** Tamami jumps up, fully healed and energized.
 - *Torey:* "**Tatami-sensei!** You are alive!"
 - *Tamami:* "Tamami! And it's sens- oh. You doofus, what are you doing risking your life like that for me!?"
- **THE DEBT:** Midori notes she sensed a "noble heart" in Tamami.
 - Tamami realizes the hero is hurt because of her. "No. Midori. This-this is my fault."
 - *Love's Pitch:* "In that we agree, hag. My best fighter got out of commission saving you. What are you going to do about it?"
 - *The Pledge:* Tamami bows deeply. "I am in great debt, I shall repay you as soon as possible!"
- **THE CLIFFHANGER:** A thunderous roar shakes the alley.
 - *Love:* "Hear that, hag? That may be your hospital bill."